

- Helps protect against brute-force SSH and web login attacks.

3. File System Access Control

- Appropriate **file and directory permissions** were applied
- Sensitive directories such as `storage`, `.env`, and `vendor` are protected from public access.
- `sudo` access restricted to only trusted users.

4. Environment File Protection

- The `.env` file was secured by:
 - Blocking direct web access using `.htaccess` rules.
 - Limiting file permissions to the web server and application user only.
- Environment variables such as database credentials, keys, and tokens are encrypted or masked when logged.

5. SSL Implementation

- HTTPS enforced using SSL certificates.
- Certificates installed via Certbot and a third-party provider (host on net).
- Redirect rules added to ensure all traffic is served over HTTPS.

Laravel Application Security

1. CSRF Protection

- Laravel's built-in CSRF middleware (`VerifyCsrfToken`) is active on all web routes.
- Tokens automatically injected into forms and verified on submission.

2. HTTPS Redirection